

Mission GoBoult

Inside Varun Gupta's ₹800 crore Make-in-India reinvention

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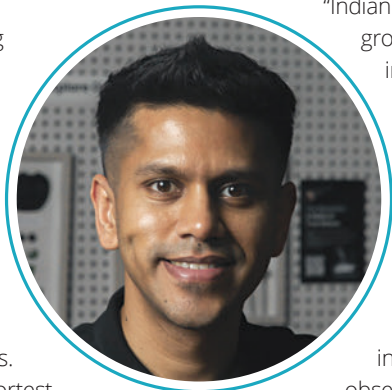
"GoBoult represents our transformation from today to tomorrow," declares

Varun Gupta, co-founder and CEO of India's home-grown audio and wearables powerhouse. On August 4, 2025, after eight years of making "neckbands and TWS earphones" and scaling from an online disruptor to a ₹750 crore brand in FY24, Gupta unveiled a strategic rebirth. Boult Audio is gone, GoBoult is here with a new name, logo, and identity destined for higher-end horizons.

"Go is one of the shortest yet most powerful words in the English dictionary," Gupta explains, "It showcases speed, energy, momentum, and for us it means transformation."

Gupta's tale reads like a founder's manifesto. He and his co-founder bootstrapped Boult in 2017, initially selling exclusively on Myntra before conquering Amazon and Flipkart.

Today, "GoBoult is the only profitable – and fastest-growing – audio-wearables player in India, commanding the No. 2 market share in audio and No. 3 in smartwatches," emphasises Gupta, a fact validated by 2024's CMR study. "We sell a product every three seconds, we sold products in the last eight years to 3 crore plus customers, last year we clocked ₹750 plus crores in revenue, this year we're trending to ₹1000 crores," he adds.



Varun Gupta
Co-founder and CEO,
GoBoult

Make in India and local R&D

At the heart of GoBoult's new chapter is a commitment to India-first manufacturing. "Since 2022, we have ventured into Make in India," Gupta notes, recounting pains of shifting China imports to Indian production.

This move, he says, granted "control, speed, and ability to do research and development." In a market where

"Indian consumers have grown towards Make in India products," the shift became a point of pride and a marketing differentiator, highlights Gupta. "They believe Made in India is better than Made in China," Gupta observes, citing glowing retailer feedback on the "Make in India" tag's direct boost to conversions.

Indeed, local R&D will receive a ₹25 crore injection this year. Gupta lays out four pillars:

1. **Design-first innovation** across more than 15 models,
2. **AI-first products**, acknowledging "it's not the future, it's the present,"
3. **App development** for seamless TWS and smartwatch experiences, and
4. **Core audio features** such as active noise cancellation, vital in India's cacophonous commutes.

"Building a large-scale factory isn't up our sleeve," Gupta clarifies. GoBoult remains "a design-first, research-first, and marketing-first company," leveraging in-house production for quality control and knowledge transfer rather

than mass manufacturing. Despite robust functional prowess, GoBoult recognized a gap in emotional engagement. Gupta recounts experiments with Ford Mustang-branded TWS at ₹1,800–2,500 that grossed over ₹100 crore, and a Dolby-partnered series that "performed phenomenally well." Yet consumer psychology resisted paying steep premiums for the same Boult moniker.

Thoughts on competition and market trends

The audio-wearables sector is fiercely contested. Yet domestic players – GoBoult included – now control over 70% market share, sidelining Chinese brands to a 15–20% slice and Western incumbents to under 8%. According to Gupta, "all my competition is bleeding money," with many burning cash to chase volumes. In contrast, GoBoult's profitable, bootstrapped model enables sustainable growth.

He observes signs of market stabilization and warns that price wars alone won't win hearts. "When any company starts flattening brands, it is because of a lack of new acquisition of customers," Gupta explains. GoBoult's answer: emotional resonance, premium lines, and collaborations that elevate brand stature.

GoBoult's vision extends well beyond India's borders. With "10 million-plus customers' first-party data" fueling insights, Gupta plans "global expansion & IPO readiness" as future growth levers. The company is charting entry strategies in Southeast Asia and the Middle East, where Make in India credentials and price-to-performance ratios may resonate strongly.

"We don't want to be complacent," he stresses. "We're planning to premiumize, go global, and plan for an IPO." This bold playbook under an hints at GoBoult's aim to join publicly traded consumer-tech champions. **d**

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